

Program Complementarity: Is Voucher + Training Superadditive?

Feedback & Improvement Report

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1. Score Breakdown

Aggregate score: 88.5/100 | Gate: PASSED | Threshold: 85/100



What each score means

Identification (86/100):

Measures the credibility of the causal design. Depends on: valid control group, flat pre-trends, exogenous treatment, and addressed confounders. Simultaneous/universal treatments (no control group) cap this at ~85.

Code (87/100):

Code quality: scripts run without errors, outputs exist, SE clustering present, pre-trend tests implemented, and referee checklist requirements addressed.

Paper (97/100):

Paper completeness: all sections present, references resolve, tables and figures exist, word count in range, key numbers in abstract match results.

Polish (74/100):

Average referee score from peer review. Reflects identification credibility, result presentation, and robustness. Hardest to improve without better data.

Replication (100/100):

Whether all scripts reproduce identical outputs when re-run. 100 = perfect replication.

2. Why the Results Look Like This

Main findings

?: coef = +0.3990

?: coef = +0.0216

? : coef = -0.0153
? : coef = +0.4009
? : coef = +0.0225
? : coef = -0.0159

Robustness summary

Key robustness checks

? : -0.0642
? : -0.1610
? : -0.0186
? : +0.3857
? : +16.4271
? : +10.0962
? : +1.8271
? : +0.1997
? : -0.1655
? : +0.1937

3. Data Limitations

Current data

Rows: 2,322 | Columns: 1420 | Structure: pooled-cross-sections

External validity

Experimental results may not generalize beyond the study sample. The specific population, setting, and time period limit extrapolation.

Demand effects

Survey/lab experiments may be subject to demand effects where respondents guess the hypothesis and adjust their responses.

Unresolved referee concerns

The following issues were flagged by referees and may limit the paper's publishability: Report take-up/compliance rates by arm and estimate LATE via 2SLS (IV) for at mi; Explain the mechanism behind the midline-to-endline sample size increase (N=1,20; Explain the 29 percentage point collapse in control-group LFP from midline (77.1

4. Validator Results

Code: hard 0/12, soft 0/9

[FAIL] seed_set:00_clean.py: No random seed set

[FAIL] validated_package: No validated econometrics package (pyfixest/csddid/linearmodels) detected

[FAIL] referee_checklist_coverage: Referee checklist: 18/31 MUST requirements detected in code (58%)

[FAIL] referee_checklist_missing: Possibly unimplemented: [DOMAIN] estimation: Primary specification: OLS/LPM with the 2x2 factorial inter; [DOMAIN] estimation: ITT estimates as the headline. If compliance < 1, also repo; [DOMAIN] estimation: ANCOVA specification: include baseline value of the outcome; [DOMAIN] estimation: Wave/period fixed effects for pooled cross-sections. Verify; [DOMAIN] data_construction: With 1,420 columns, implement explicit variable sele ... and 8 more

Paper: hard 0/4, soft 0/5

[FAIL] word_count: 4690 words (outside 5000-15000 range)

Integration: hard 0/6, soft 0/11

5. Recommendations to Improve Score

[FROM REFEREES] Must-address issues from peer review

1. Report take-up/compliance rates by arm and estimate LATE via 2SLS (IV) for at minimum employment and LFP outcomes; first-stage statistics required.
2. Explain the mechanism behind the midline-to-endline sample size increase (N=1,207 ? N=1,255): re-contact, refreshment, or administrative additions. Test arm balance among re-appearing observations and
3. Explain the 29 percentage point collapse in control-group LFP from midline (77.1%) to endline (48.0%): rule out survey instrument changes, document seasonal/macroeconomic confounds, examine differenti
4. Characterize the 975 excluded individuals (42% of baseline) on observable baseline characteristics relative to the randomized sample; provide baseline balance tests and exogeneity assessment for the e

[HIGH IMPACT] Improve identification strategy

Add exogenous variation: natural experiments, policy discontinuities, staggered rollout, or instrumental variables. RCTs score highest.

[MEDIUM IMPACT] Improve code quality

Address referee checklist gaps. Use validated packages (pyfixest, linearmodels) instead of manual implementations. Add missing robustness checks flagged by the code validator.

[LOW IMPACT (depends on above)] Address referee feedback

Polish improves when identification and code improve. Focus on must-address issues listed above.

6. Estimated Score Impact

Stronger identification (RCT or natural experiment): +10 to +20 identification

Address all referee must-address issues: +5 to +10 polish

Address all SHOULD-address issues: +3 to +5 polish

Current aggregate: 88.5/100. Estimated ceiling with current data: ~88. To reach 90+: need RCT or strong natural experiment data.